

I am visualizing the Our World in Data Energy Consumption by type dataset <https://ourworldindata.org/energy-production-consumption>. This dataset includes the energy consumed by each country as well as some other regions such as continents or economic regions. It is however missing data from a lot of countries, especially those in Africa.

To visualize the data I used a bar chart and Pie charts. The bar chart is useful because it can show every year for multiple countries at once which give more data instantly. It also divided the energy consumption by type which can show growth and shrinkage of industries. The bar chart only allows for 8 countries to be chosen since the graph would become too cluttered with more. The countries the user can choose from are the only ones with real data in the dataset.

My second approach was to use pie charts, showing the percentage of energy in each category for multiple countries or regions each year. I used pie charts because they can convey the data for all 32 countries simultaneously and allow the user to select a year or drag between time to see changes.

I think that the utility of my bar charts is pretty useful and I also think the bars really show the percentages well, I do think that using a search feature where the user can type in a country would be easier than having them click and know the codes for each country, however this was still fine for the limited dataset.

I think that the pie chart is also useful with the time scroll feature as it allows you to really see the collapse of industries like nuclear power in Germany. I also think it is one of the best ways to allow the user to select any year without being overwhelmed with data. It could be better if the user was able to choose the 32 countries but I decided against that since it would give too many options and not be as symmetrical.

I really like my final colour scheme for the types of energy as I think they give good contrast while holding some of the physical color of the object they represent. I made gas purple to represent the color of gas burning rather than make it clear and I made oil yellow to represent its unrefined state and not get confused with coal.